VIT BHOPAL UNIVERSITY
School of Computing Science and Engineering

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

Project Report

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Introduction

When I first heard about the Digital Literacy course, honestly, I thought it would just be another formality – something to sit through and submit at the end. But the more I started working through the tasks, the more I realized how much I had been taking for granted. I had a LinkedIn account but barely knew what to write on it. I used email every day but never really thought about whether I was writing it the right way.

This project is my attempt to put together a Digital Literacy Portfolio – a collection of things I learned, built, and reflected on across five modules. Each task pushed me to actually do something, not just read about it. Whether it was designing an infographic, setting up my GitHub profile, completing a coding challenge, writing a formal email, or understanding cybercrime – every task taught me something I will genuinely use going forward.

As a first-year CSE student, I am just starting my journey. This portfolio is the beginning of my digital presence – and I plan to keep building on it over the next four years.

Task 1 | Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

What I Made

For this task, I used Canva – the free browser-based design tool – to create a one-page infographic called "Be Digitally Smart". I had never really used Canva properly before (I'd opened it once but just closed it), so figuring out the layout took a bit of time. I went with a clean blue-and-white colour scheme because it looked more professional than the colourful templates.

My infographic covers three main topics:

- What Digital Literacy is – I defined it as the ability to find, evaluate, use, and create information using digital tools responsibly.
- Useful Digital Tools for Students – I highlighted tools like Google Drive, Canva, GitHub, and VS Code that are actually helpful for a CSE student.
- Safe Internet Practices – I included tips on using strong passwords, not sharing personal info online, and checking URLs before clicking.

Tool Used

Canva (canva.com) – free version. I used a pre-made infographic template and customized it with my own content, colour choices, and icons.

Reflection

The most difficult part was deciding what to include and what to leave out. I initially wanted to cover five topics but the layout got too crowded. I learned that good design is actually about making choices – what not to show matters as much as what you do show. The most interesting part was finding the right icons that matched the message without looking too busy.

Task 2 | Student Digital Portfolio Setup

Platforms

For this task, I set up accounts on three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. Here is a quick overview of each:

Platform	What it is used for	My plan for it
GitHub	Version control and code portfolio for developers	Upload all my lab work and projects; build my coding profile
LinkedIn	Professional networking, internship and job applications	Connect with seniors, follow companies, apply for internships by 2nd year
Kaggle	Data science competitions, datasets, and machine learning notebooks	Start learning data science basics; participate in beginner competitions

GitHub Profile README

On GitHub, I created a special repository named after my username and added a profile README. It includes my name, branch, current year, and a short line about what I hope to learn – "I am a first-year CSE student at VIT Bhopal who wants to build things that actually work and maybe understand how they work too."

Reflection

Setting up LinkedIn was slightly uncomfortable at first because I felt like I had nothing to show yet. But I realised that everyone starts somewhere, and even filling in your education section and adding a basic summary counts as a step forward. The GitHub README was the most fun part – it's the first thing people see when they visit your profile, and it's completely yours to customise. Over four years, I want all three of these profiles to actually say something meaningful about my work.

Task 3 | Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Part A – Coding Practice Platform

I chose HackerRank for the coding practice part. I created an account and completed the "Solve Me First" challenge under the Algorithms section. The task was simple – add two numbers and print the sum – but that's not really the point. The point was getting familiar with the submission interface, reading problem statements carefully, and understanding how test cases work.

I also attempted the Python Introduction challenge (print a string), which gave me a bronze badge for Python basics. Not going to lie, I felt oddly proud of that tiny badge.

Part B – Google Forms Collaboration

I created a Google Form titled "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" with exactly 5 questions for my batchmates. Here is what I included:

- Q1 (Multiple Choice): Which of the following is NOT a safe internet practice?
- Q2 (Short Answer): What does the term 'phishing' mean in the context of cybersecurity?
- Q3 (Multiple Choice): Which platform is primarily used for code version control?
- Q4 (Multiple Choice): What is the full form of UPI?
- Q5 (Short Answer): Name one tool you would use to create a professional infographic.

The linked Google Sheet automatically records responses, which is useful for seeing how many people actually know about digital safety.

Reflection

Creating the Google Form made me think more carefully about question design – making sure the questions were clear, not too easy, and actually relevant to what someone should know. HackerRank taught me that even simple problems require reading the problem statement properly; I made a mistake on the first try because I did not read the input format carefully. These tools will definitely help me academically – HackerRank for placement prep and Google Forms for any surveys or peer feedback I might need to gather in group projects.

Task 4 | Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Part A – Email 1: Requesting Assignment Deadline Extension

Subject: Request for Extension on Assignment Submission – CSE0201 (Section B)

Dear Dr. Meena,

I hope this email finds you well. I am writing to respectfully request a short extension on the upcoming assignment submission for CSE0201, which is due on 22nd March 2026.

Over the past week, I have been unwell with a viral fever and missed two lab sessions as a result. While I have completed most of the assignment, I need two additional days to review and correct a few sections properly rather than submit incomplete work.

I understand that deadlines are important and I do not wish to make this a habit. I would be grateful if you could consider allowing me to submit by 24th March 2026. I am happy to provide a medical certificate if required.

Thank you for your time and understanding.

Yours sincerely,
Firoz Ahmad Khan

Part A – Email 2: Internship Interest Expression

Subject: Expression of Interest – Summer Internship Opportunity 2025

Dear Hiring Team / Ms. Priya Verma,

I am writing to express my interest in the summer internship programme at TechNova Solutions. I am currently a first-year B.Tech student in Computer Science and Engineering at VIT Bhopal University, and I am eager to gain hands-on industry experience during the upcoming vacation period (May–June 2026).

I have a foundational understanding of programming in C++ and Python, and I have recently started building my portfolio on GitHub. I am a quick learner and I am comfortable with tools like Google Workspace and Canva. Although I am early in my academic journey, I am genuinely motivated to contribute and learn in a real work environment.

I would be grateful for the opportunity to discuss any available openings suitable for a first-year student. I have attached my CV and GitHub profile link for your reference.

Thank you for your consideration. I look forward to hearing from you.

Warm regards,
Firoz Ahmad Khan

Part B – Social Media Do's and Don'ts

✓ DO's	✗ DON'Ts
Keep your profile photo and bio professional, especially on LinkedIn	Don't post anything in anger or frustration – you can always come back and post it later (or not)
Think before you post – ask yourself if you'd be okay with your professor or future employer seeing it	Don't share your location in real time on public accounts
Use privacy settings to control who sees your posts and personal info	Don't engage with trolls or hostile comments – block and move on
Give credit when sharing others' work, images, or ideas	Don't spread unverified news or forward WhatsApp messages without checking the source
Report cyberbullying or harmful content using platform tools	Don't share personal details like your address, phone number, or Aadhaar number on any social platform

Reflection

I once read about an incident where a college student from Mumbai was rejected from a company's hiring process after the recruiter found old posts on their Twitter account where they had been mocking their previous employer. The student had not even remembered posting those things – they were from three years earlier. The company withdrew the offer without any explanation, and the student only found out through a mutual connection later.

What could have been done differently: The student should have done a regular audit of their social media accounts – at least once every six months – and deleted any posts that could be misread in a professional context. More importantly, they should not have posted those things in the first place. What feels like venting in the moment can follow you for years online.

Task 5 | Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Part A – Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

Raghav is a second-year college student in Pune who runs a small business selling handmade bookmarks on Instagram. One day, a buyer named 'Raj' messaged her saying he wanted to order 20 bookmarks and would pay via Google Pay. He sent her a QR code saying "scan this to receive payment of Rs. 800".

Raghav scanned the QR code, entered her UPI PIN as prompted, and lost Rs. 800 from her account instantly. 'Raj' disappeared from Instagram immediately after.

How the Fraud Happened (Step by Step)

- Step 1: The attacker identified Priya as a small seller who was comfortable with UPI but may not have fully understood QR code mechanics.
- Step 2: The attacker created a 'Request Money' QR code (not a payment QR) using a standard UPI app and sent it to Priya, disguised as a 'payment QR'.
- Step 3: Raghav, trusting that QR codes are always for receiving payments, scanned it and entered her PIN – which in reality authorised a debit from her account.
- Step 4: The attacker received the money and blocked Raghav.

This type of fraud specifically targets young sellers and students because they are familiar with UPI but may not know the difference between a 'Collect Request' and a 'Pay' QR code. The key lesson is simple but critical: you NEVER enter your UPI PIN to receive money – only to send it.

Part B – Stay Safe Online: Prevention Checklist

#	Prevention Tip
1	Never enter your UPI PIN to receive money – you only need it to send.
2	Set a transaction limit on your UPI app to reduce damage if you are ever scammed.
3	Use different passwords for different accounts. If one is hacked, the others stay safe. Use a password manager if needed.
4	Always verify URLs before clicking – check for https:// and look for typos in the domain name (e.g., 'amaz0n.com' is fake).
5	Do not connect to public Wi-Fi for banking or any sensitive activity. Use your mobile data instead.
6	Enable two-factor authentication (2FA) on all your important accounts – email, GitHub, LinkedIn.
7	If you receive an unexpected OTP, do not share it with anyone – not even someone claiming to be a bank official.
8	If you are being cyberbullied, screenshot the evidence and report it on the platform. Do not engage or respond to the attacker.
9	Report any cybercrime at the National Cyber Crime Portal: cybercrime.gov.in or call Helpline 1930 (available 24x7).

Reflection

The thing that surprised me most while working on this task was how simple the UPI QR scam actually is. I had assumed that online fraud involved complicated hacking or technical tricks. But this type of scam requires no technical knowledge at all – it exploits a gap in user understanding, not a gap in technology. The attacker just needs to count on the victim not knowing the difference between a payment QR and a collection request.

The one habit I will personally change: I used to scan any QR code without thinking twice. Now, before I enter my UPI PIN anywhere, I will make sure I actually intended to initiate a payment, not receive one. That single mental check could prevent a lot of damage.

Conclusion

Working through this project was more useful than I expected. When I look at what I submitted across these five tasks, I can actually see something that did not exist a few weeks ago – a digital presence. GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle accounts that are actually set up; emails I can write with confidence; a checklist that might actually help a batchmate avoid getting scammed.

The biggest takeaway for me was not any single tool or skill – it was the idea that being digitally literate is not about knowing every platform or every trick. It is about being intentional: thinking before you post, reading before you click, and understanding what you are agreeing to before you enter your PIN. I am glad this was part of the first year, because everything else we do in CSE will involve these skills in some way.

References

- Canva Design Tool – canva.com
- GitHub – github.com
- LinkedIn – linkedin.com
- Kaggle – kaggle.com
- HackerRank – hackerrank.com
- Google Forms – forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal – cybercrime.gov.in
- Cyber Crime Helpline – 1930 (Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India)
- VIT Bhopal University – vitbhopal.ac.in